

CleanTech Open 2025: Scorer & Evaluation Manual

Step-by-step instructions for evaluating startup applications, utilizing the AI Due Diligence Copilot, and navigating founder deliverables with auto-citation jumping.

Target: Expert Judges,
Mentors & Investors

Portal URL:
/index.html

Evaluation Framework: 10
Categories (282 Criteria)

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1 Getting Started & Logging In

As a CleanTech Open judge, you have been assigned specific cleantech startups to evaluate. Your evaluations determine accelerator cohort admissions, awards, and investment readiness.

1. Navigate to the scoring portal at **/index.html**.
2. In the **Judge Authentication** modal, enter:
 - **Scorer ID:** Your assigned username (e.g., judge_smith or J-001).
 - **Passcode:** Your individual access passcode provided by the administrator.
3. Click **Sign In**.
4. In the top navigation header, click the **Company Dropdown** to view the startups assigned to you. Select the startup you wish to evaluate to load its application workspace.

Auto-Save Security: Every score selection and justification text box is **automatically saved to the cloud** the moment you click or pause typing. You can safely reload the page, switch categories, or return later without losing any work.

2 The 3-Column Evaluation Workspace

The scoring interface is organized into three synchronized panels designed to minimize context switching and maximize diligence velocity:

1. CATEGORIES

● Business

Canvas (5)

- Environmental & Social (12)
- Product Market Fit (24)
- Market & Customers (18)
- Tech / Product (22)
- Financials (31)
- Team Targets (15)
- Legal & Governance (42)
- Executive Summary (20)
- Investor Pitch (58)

2. EVALUATION CARDS

How clearly is the value proposition understood?

1 PT 0.75 0.5 0

AI: 1 PT | 95% Conf

 [View AI Citation \(p. 1\)](#)

3. LIVE PDF VIEWER

Canvas PDF Pitch Deck

[Embedded Deliverable PDF Viewer — Auto jumps to active page]

3 The AI Due Diligence Copilot & Citation Auto-Jumping

Every criterion has been pre-analyzed by our high-conviction clean AI extraction engine. The AI does not replace your expertise; it highlights verbatim founder claims and surfaces key passages instantly.

Anatomy of an Evaluation Card

- **Question & Criteria:** The exact scoring question formulated by the CleanTech Open national curriculum.
- **AI Suggestion Pill:** Displays the AI's predicted score (e.g. Val: 1.0 PT) alongside an empirical confidence score (e.g. 95% Conf).
- **Point Buttons:** Standardized score radio buttons. Click any button to record your score.
- **"View AI Citation (p. X)" Link:** The core diligence accelerator. Clicking this link triggers two actions:
 1. Expands the yellow citation box displaying the exact verbatim sentence from the founder's submission.
 2. **Instantly switches the PDF viewer on the right to the matching document and automatically jumps directly to Page X!**

INTERACTIVE CITATION BLOCK (EXPANDED)

AUTOMATIC PDF AUTO-JUMP

AI Citation (Page 1):

 02_17_Inc_-_Biz_Model_Canvas.pdf

"For clean energy producers who seek to store, distribute and monetize their surplus peak time energy production, 17 offers a scalable intermittent ammonia production solution. Unlike battery packs, ammonia can be transported, used for energy production and as a fertilizer."

 Switched viewer to Page 1. Use **Cmd+F** (Mac) or **Ctrl+F** (Windows) in the viewer to locate exact text.

4 Scoring Philosophy & Human Overrides

Rule 1 — You Are the Ultimate Authority: The AI Copilot is calibrated to identify explicit keywords and founder claims. If you discover that a claim is unvalidated, technologically dubious, or contradicts another deliverable, **override the AI score immediately.**

When is Human Justification Required?

To maintain scoring integrity for founders, human written justifications are mandatory for:

- All 5 questions in the **Business Canvas (BC)** category.
- Key subjective pivot questions across **Financials (F)**, **Tech Validation (TP)**, and **Investor Pitch (IP)**.
- Any evaluation where you **dramatically downgrade an AI suggestion** from 1.0 PT to 0.0 PT.

A yellow text area labeled "*Human Justification / Diligence Notes*" will appear automatically. Enter 1 to 2 concise sentences explaining the rationale behind your verdict.

5 Step-by-Step Diligence Checklist

Follow this standardized 5-step workflow for every startup assigned to you:

Step	Action	Description & Best Practice
Step 1	Executive Summary	Start in the Executive Summary (IS) category to read the founder's 1-page overview and understand the core thesis.
Step 2	Category Progression	Progress systematically through the 10 categories using the left navigation sidebar. Watch the progress ring fill as criteria are answered.
Step 3	Inspect Citations	On each question, click " View AI Citation " to verify the founder's claim against the embedded PDF deliverable on the right.
Step 4	Record Score & Notes	Select your point verdict. If the question requires justification or if you disagree with the AI, type your brief explanation.
Step 5	Final Verification	Ensure all 10 categories show 100% completion in the sidebar. When finished, switch to the next assigned company in the header dropdown.

6 Scorer FAQs & Pro-Tips

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if the AI Citation says "No direct evidence exists"?

A: This means the startup's submitted deliverables did not address this specific criterion. If you independently search the document and cannot locate evidence, award **0 PTS**.

Q: Can I view the official rubric scoring guidelines?

A: Yes! On questions with official rubric guidelines, click the " **View Examples**" link in the question card to view rubric thresholds and real-world grading examples.

Q: How do I zoom or download a startup PDF?

A: The live PDF viewer on the right includes full browser controls in the top toolbar: zoom in/out (+/-), page jump, and a direct download icon to inspect the file in your preferred PDF reader.

Q: What if I notice a document misclassification?

A: All deliverables are mapped across category tabs above the PDF viewer. If you need to view a document filed under another category (e.g. Financial Projection while reviewing Business Canvas), simply click that category's tab at the top of the viewer.

Q: How long should each startup take?

A: Thanks to citation auto-jumping, an evaluation typically takes **45 to 60 minutes** per startup.

